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Determining substrate precession with acoustic signals

Abstract

A chemical mechanical polishing apparatus includes a platen to support a polishing pad, a carrier head to hold a surface of a substrate against the polishing pad, a motor to generate relative motion between the platen and the carrier head so as to polish an overlying layer on the substrate, an in-situ acoustic monitoring system comprising an acoustic sensor that receives acoustic signals from the surface of the substrate, and a controller configured to determine an angular orientation of the substrate based on received acoustic signals from the in-situ acoustic monitoring system.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of priority to U.S. Application No. 63/349,020, filed on Jun. 3, 2022, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

(1) This disclosure relates to in-situ monitoring of chemical mechanical polishing, and in particular to acoustic monitoring.

BACKGROUND

(2) An integrated circuit is typically formed on a substrate by the sequential deposition of conductive, semiconductive, or insulative layers on a silicon wafer. One fabrication step involves depositing a filler layer over a non-planar surface and planarizing the filler layer. For certain applications, the filler layer is planarized until the top surface of a patterned layer is exposed. A conductive filler layer, for example, can be deposited on a patterned insulative layer to fill the trenches or holes in the insulative layer. After planarization, the portions of the metallic layer remaining between the raised pattern of the insulative layer form vias, plugs, and lines that provide conductive paths between thin film circuits on the substrate. For other applications, such as oxide polishing, the filler layer is planarized, e.g., by polishing for a predetermined time period, to leave a portion of the filler layer over the nonplanar surface. In addition, planarization of the substrate surface is usually required for photolithography.

(3) Chemical mechanical polishing (CMP) is one accepted method of planarization. This planarization method typically requires that the substrate be mounted on a carrier or polishing head. The exposed surface of the substrate is typically placed against a rotating polishing pad. The carrier head provides a controllable load on the substrate to push it against the polishing pad. An abrasive polishing slurry is typically supplied to the surface of the polishing pad.

(4) During polishing, a substrate can be subjected to an “asymmetric” removal profile, i.e., the amount removed varies with the angular position around the center of the substrate (rather than only with the radial distance from the center of the substrate). Also, prior to being polished, the substrate can have an initial asymmetrically non-uniform thickness profile.

SUMMARY

(5) Disclosed herein is a chemical mechanical polishing apparatus including an in-situ acoustic monitoring system arranged in a platen. The carrier head induces motion between the substrate and the polishing pad atop the platen. The acoustic monitoring system receives acoustic signals as the substrate is swept over the acoustic sensor. The acoustic signals originate from the interface between the substrate surface and the polishing pad and vary with time according to the polishing stage and material exposed on the substrate surface. In some stages, the acoustic signals vary periodically according to the substrate angular orientation with respect to the acoustic sensor. Detecting this periodic variation facilitates determination of the angular orientation of the substrate within the carrier head. The substrate angular orientation can be determined as a function of time, and predicted angular orientations generated for any time point from the initiation of polishing.

(6) In one aspect, a chemical mechanical polishing apparatus includes a platen to support a polishing pad, a carrier head to hold a surface of a substrate against the polishing pad, a motor to generate relative motion between the platen and the carrier head so as to polish an overlying layer on the substrate, an in-situ acoustic monitoring system comprising an acoustic sensor that receives acoustic signals from the surface of the substrate, and a controller configured to determine an angular orientation of the substrate based on received acoustic signals from the in-situ acoustic monitoring system.

(7) In another aspect, a method includes bringing a substrate into contact with a polishing pad, generating relative motion between the substrate and the polishing pad to polish an overlying layer on the substrate, monitoring acoustic signals from the surface of the substrate with an acoustic sensor, and determining an angular orientation of the substrate based on the monitored acoustic signals.

(8) In another aspect, a chemical mechanical polishing system includes a transfer station having a sensor that generates a signal that depends on an angular orientation of the substrate, a polishing

station a platen to support a polishing pad, a carrier head to hold a surface of the substrate against the polishing pad, a motor to generate relative motion between the platen and the carrier head so as to polish an overlying layer on the substrate, an in-situ acoustic monitoring system comprising an acoustic sensor that receives acoustic signals from the surface of the substrate, and a controller. The controller is configured to receive a signal from the sensor in the transfer station and determine an initial angular orientation of the substrate before polishing based on the signal, to determine a rate of change of angular orientation of the substrate based on received acoustic signals from the in-situ acoustic monitoring system, and to determine an angular orientation of the substrate from the initial angular orientation and the rate of change.

(9) In another aspect, a chemical mechanical polishing system includes polishing station having a platen to support a polishing pad, a rotatable carrier head to hold a surface of a substrate against the polishing pad, a motor to generate relative motion between the platen and the carrier head so as to polish an overlying layer on the substrate, an in-situ acoustic monitoring system comprising an acoustic sensor that receives acoustic signals from the surface of the substrate, and a controller. The controller is configured to determine a rate of change of angular orientation of the substrate based on received acoustic signals from the in-situ acoustic monitoring system, to obtain a rotation rate of the carrier head, and to determine a difference in angular orientation between the substrate and the carrier head based on the rate of change of angular orientation of the substrate and the rotation rate of the carrier head.

(10) Implementations may include one or more of the following features. The acoustic sensor may be a passive acoustic sensor. The controller may be configured to determine an angular orientation of the substrate based on a signal from a notch detector in the carrier head and acoustic signals from the in-situ acoustic monitoring system.

(11) Particular implementations of the subject matter described in this specification can be implemented so as to realize one or more of the following technical advantages.

(12) Wafer-to-wafer (WTW) and within-wafer (WIW) polishing uniformity can be improved. Angularly dependent non-uniformity can be reduced. Software of existing acoustic monitoring systems can be updated to detect the angular orientation acoustic signals without requiring new hardware, which decreases cost of ownership. Determining a time-varying function representing the angular orientation of the substrate allows extrapolation of the angular orientation, which permits application of angularly dependent pressures to increase material removal accuracy.

(13) The details of one or more embodiments are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features and advantages will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic cross-sectional view of an example polishing apparatus.

(2) FIG. 2A illustrates a top view of the polishing pad upper surface atop the platen and a carrier head retaining a substrate.

(3) FIG. 2B illustrates a bottom view of a carrier head.

(4) FIG. 3A is a graph showing an exemplary acoustic signal.

(5) FIG. 3B is an exploded view of a portion of the acoustic signal of FIG. 3A.

(6) FIGS. 4A and 4B illustrate exemplary orientations of a substrate having parallel register lines with respect to a direction of travel of an acoustic sensor.

(7) FIGS. 5A-5E illustrate exemplary angular orientations of an exemplary substrate from a direction of travel of the acoustic sensor of FIG. 2.

(8) FIG. 6 illustrates exemplary angular orientations of an exemplary substrate having a flat.

(9) FIG. 7 illustrates a schematic cross-sectional view of a loading station.

(10) In the figures, like references indicate like elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) As noted above, during polishing a substrate can be subjected to an asymmetric removal profile or can have an initial asymmetrically non-uniform thickness profile. Hypothetically a carrier head could include multiple chambers disposed angularly around a center axis, and different pressures could be applied to the angularly disposed chambers to compensate for the asymmetry. However, a problem is that during polishing the substrate “precesses,” i.e., rotates relative to the carrier head. Thus, how the chambers need to be pressurized to compensate for asymmetry will change over time (since a given chamber will not always correspond to the same angular position on the substrate). Consequently determination of the substrate orientation relative to the substrate would be useful in order to correctly determine polishing parameters to compensate for asymmetry.

(12) A carrier head with optical sensors has been proposed to monitor the substrate orientation. However, such techniques have been difficult to implement, and in any event require a change in equipment. Thus, there is room for improvement in techniques to determine the orientation of the substrate within the carrier head (even if used for purposes other than compensating for asymmetry as discussed for above).

(13) A technique that may be able to determine substrate orientation is acoustic monitoring. Without being limited to a theory, a device substrate, i.e., a substrate being used in integrated circuit device fabrication (as opposed to a blank substrate or bare silicon wafer), typically has patterned features. The patterned features can include small scale features such as the nanometer-scale plateaus and trenches and larger scale features such as circuitry dies aligned along regular arrays. Still without being limited to theory, as the substrate precesses (e.g., undergoes precession), these features can move into and out of alignment with the relative direction of travel of the asperities of the polishing layer of the polishing pad. This can result in a change in the acoustic signal.

(14) In operation, the platen including the acoustic sensor rotates at a first speed to carry the sensor below the substrate at a sweep frequency, and the substrate rotates at a second speed.

Measurements received each time the acoustic sensor sweeps beneath the substrate provide periodic measurements taken when the substrate is at varying rotational positions, e.g., at various orientations in the precession of the substrate beneath the carrier head. The sweep frequency and substrate rotational frequency create a periodic signal based on the beat frequency of the two rotation rates. The peaks or valleys of the periodic signal corresponds with the alignment of the patterned features and the asperity direction of travel.

(15) The precession rate, i.e., the rotational rate of the substrate relative to the carrier head, can be determined by detecting this signal and determining parameters of the periodic alignment signal.

(16) FIG. 1 illustrates an example of a polishing apparatus **100**. The polishing apparatus **100** includes a rotatable disk-shaped platen **120** on which a polishing pad **110** is situated. The polishing pad **110** can be a two-layer polishing pad with an outer polishing layer **112** and a softer backing layer **114**. The platen is operable to rotate about an axis of rotation **125**. For example, a motor **121**, e.g., a DC induction motor, can turn a drive shaft **124** to rotate the platen **120**.

(17) The polishing apparatus **100** can include a port **130** to dispense polishing liquid **132**, such as abrasive slurry, onto the polishing pad **110** to the pad. The polishing apparatus can also include a polishing pad conditioner to abrade the polishing pad **110** to maintain the polishing pad **110** in a consistent abrasive state.

(18) The polishing apparatus **100** includes a carrier head **140** operable to hold a substrate **10** against the polishing pad **110**. The carrier head **140** can include a retaining ring **142** to retain the substrate **10** below a flexible membrane **144**. The carrier head **140** also includes one or more independently controllable pressurizable chambers defined by the membrane, e.g., three chambers **146a-146c**, which can apply independently controllable pressurizes to associated zones on the flexible

membrane **144** and thus on the substrate **10**. Although only three chambers are illustrated in FIG. **1** for ease of illustration, there could be one or two chambers, or four or more chambers, e.g., nine to thirteen chambers. In addition, although FIG. **1** illustrates the chambers as radially arranged, as shown in FIG. **2B** the carrier head can include multiple chambers, e.g., chambers **146a-f**, distributed angularly around a center axis of the carrier head. This permits angular variation in the applied pressure in order to compensate for polishing asymmetry.

(19) The carrier head **140** is suspended from a support structure **150**, e.g., a carousel or track, and is connected by a drive shaft **152** to a carrier head rotation motor **154**, e.g., a DC induction motor, so that the carrier head can rotate about an axis **155**. Optionally each carrier head **140** can oscillate laterally, e.g., on sliders on the support structure **150**, or by rotational oscillation of the carousel itself, or by sliding along the track. In typical operation, the platen is rotated about its central axis of rotation **125**, and each carrier head is rotated about its central axis **155** and translated laterally across the top surface of the polishing pad.

(20) A controller **190**, such as a programmable computer, is connected to the motors **121**, **154** to control the rotation rate of the platen **120** and carrier head **140**. For example, each motor can include an encoder, e.g., a motor encoder, that measures the rotation rate of the associated drive shaft. A feedback control circuit, which could be in the motor itself, part of the controller, or a separate circuit, receives the measured rotation rate from the encoder and adjusts the current supplied to the motor to ensure that the rotation rate of the drive shaft matches at a rotation rate received from the controller. The encoder can also provide the orientation of the drive shaft and associate component, e.g., an encoder **156** for the drive shaft **152** can be used to determine the angular orientation of the carrier head **140**.

(21) The polishing apparatus **100** includes at least one in-situ acoustic monitoring system **160**. The in-situ acoustic monitoring system **160** includes one or more acoustic signal sensors **162** installed at one or more locations on the upper platen **120**.

(22) A position sensor, e.g., an optical interrupter connected to the rim of the platen or a rotary encoder, can be used to sense the rotational position of the platen **120**. This permits only portions of the signal measured when the sensor **162** is in proximity to the substrate **10**, e.g., when the sensor **162** is below the carrier head **140** or substrate **10**.

(23) In the implementation shown in FIG. **1**, the acoustic monitoring system **160** includes an acoustic sensor **162** positioned supported by the platen **120** to receive acoustic signals through the polishing pad **110** from the substrate **10**. The acoustic sensor **162** can be partially or entirely in a recess **164** in the top surface of the platen **120**. In some implementations, a top surface of the acoustic sensor **162** is coplanar with the top surface of the platen **120**.

(24) In some implementations, the portion of the polishing pad directly above the acoustic sensor **162** can include an acoustic window **119**, e.g., a region having lower acoustic impedance than the surrounding polishing material. The acoustic window **119** can extend through the polishing layer **112**, or the backing layer **114**, or both. However, if the acoustic transmission of the polishing pad is sufficiently high, the acoustic window **119** may not be necessary.

(25) The acoustic sensor **162** is a contact acoustic sensor having a surface connected to (e.g., in direct contact with, or having just an adhesive layer for attachment to, or having just an acoustic gel for transmission of the acoustic signal from) a portion of the polishing layer **112**, or the backing layer **114**, or the acoustic window **119**. For example, the acoustic sensor **162** can be an electromagnetic acoustic transducer or piezoelectric acoustic transducer. A piezoelectric sensor can include a rigid contact plate, e.g., of stainless steel or the like, which is placed into contact with the body to be monitored, and a piezoelectric assembly, e.g., a piezoelectric layer sandwiched between two electrodes, on the backside of the contact plate. The acoustic sensor **162** can be connected by circuitry **168** to a power supply and/or other signal processing electronics **166** through a rotary coupling, e.g., a mercury slip ring.

(26) In some implementations, the in-situ acoustic monitoring system **160** is a passive acoustic

monitoring system. In this case, signals are monitored by the acoustic sensor **162** without generating signals from an acoustic signal generator (or the acoustic signal generator can be omitted entirely from the system). The passive acoustic signals monitored by the acoustic sensor **162** can be in 20 kHz to 1 MHz range, e.g., 20 to 50 kHz, or 200 to 400 kHz, or 200 KHz to 1 MHz, depending on application. For example, for monitoring of polishing of inter-layer dielectric (ILD) in a shallow trench isolation (STI), a frequency range of 225 kHz to 350 kHz can be monitored.

(27) The signal from the sensor **162** can be amplified by a built-in internal amplifier. In some implementations, the amplification gain is between 40 and 90 dB (e.g., 50 dB or 80 dB). The signal from the acoustic sensor **162** can then be further amplified and filtered if necessary, and digitized through an A/D port to a high speed data acquisition board, e.g., in the electronics **166**. Data from the acoustic sensor **162** can be recorded at a similar range as that of the generator **163** or at a different, e.g., higher, range, e.g., from 1 to 10 MHz, e.g., 1-3 MHz or 6-8 MHz. In implementations in which the acoustic sensor **162** is a passive acoustic sensor, a frequency range from 100 kHz to 2 MHz can be monitored, such as 500 kHz to 1 MHz (e.g., 750 kHz).

(28) If positioned in the platen **120**, the acoustic sensor **162**, can be located at the center of the platen **120**, e.g., at the axis of rotation **125**, at the edge of the platen **120**, or at a midpoint (e.g., 5 inches from the axis of rotation for a 20 inch diameter platen).

(29) Referring now to FIG. 2A, a top-down view of the polishing pad **110** atop the platen **120** is shown. The substrate **10** is retained within the retaining ring **142** of the carrier head **140**. The controller **190** commands the carrier head **140** to cause the chambers **146a-146c** (see FIG. 1) to press the substrate **10** into contact with the polishing layer **112**.

(30) As the carrier head **140** presses the substrate **10** against the polishing layer **112**, the carrier head **140** rotates around the central axis **155** at a carrier head rotation rate $\omega_{\text{sub.C}}$. The substrate **10** is restrained to the area beneath the carrier head **140** by the retaining ring **142** and can move, e.g., rotate, within the enclosed area. In particular, the friction between the substrate and the inner surface of the retaining ring **142** and/or friction of the membrane **144** against the substrate **10** induces rotation in the substrate **10** at a substrate rotational rate, $\omega_{\text{sub.S}}$. The substrate rotational rate, $\omega_{\text{sub.S}}$, can be approximately, but typically not exactly, the same rotational rate $\omega_{\text{sub.C}}$ of the carrier head **140**. The difference between the rotation rate $\omega_{\text{sub.C}}$ of the carrier head and the rotation rate provides the precession rate.

(31) The platen **120** includes the acoustic window **119** in contact with the acoustic sensor **162** beneath. The acoustic sensor **162** is stationary within the recess **164** of the platen **120** while the platen **120** rotates with platen rotational rate, $\omega_{\text{sub.P}}$, and travels in a common direction of travel **200** with the rotation of the plate **120**. This sweeps the acoustic window **119** and associated acoustic sensor **162** beneath the substrate **10** within the retaining ring **142**.

(32) The acoustic sensor **162** receives an acoustic signal based on the received acoustic information from the interface between the substrate **10** and the pad **110**. FIG. 3A depicts an exemplary acoustic signal **300** generated during a polishing process. The acoustic signal **300** compares the summed power spectral density (PSD) across a frequency range on the y-axis against time, in seconds (s). The acoustic signal **300** has distinct regions, such as first region **302**, second region **304**, and third region **306** corresponding to layer transitions of the substrate **10**.

(33) Without wishing to be bound by theory, a layer transition occurs when layer topography has been removed by the apparatus **100**. In some implementations, the regions **302**, **304**, and **306** correspond to layer transitions in the substrate **10**. The polishing of topography of the substrate **10** may corresponds to a first region **302** of the signal **300** in FIG. 6. In the second region **304** of the signal **300** the acoustic signal **300** is substantially constant (albeit subject to noise). The polishing of a planar surface may correspond to a second region **304** of the acoustic signal **300**. The second region **304** continues in time until the filler layer extending above a patterned layer has been removed.

(34) The patterned layer is composed of a different material, e.g., dielectric, than the filler layer and interacts with the polishing layer **112** surface and materials differently, thereby creating a third region **306** of the acoustic signal **300**. In addition, continued polishing can create dishing, and this topology may again increase the acoustic signal. The third region **306** is not constant, e.g., can be increasing or decreasing.

(35) An expanded view of third region **306**, enclosed by box A, is depicted in FIG. 3B. The acoustic signal **310** of FIG. 3B has undergone further processing (e.g., averaging) to reduce noise, e.g., to denoise, in the acoustic signal **300**. In other examples, the denoising process can include the application of sub-sampling, averaging, binning, or windowing to the received acoustic signals.

(36) Without wishing to be bound by theory, each data point of acoustic signal **310** corresponds to a different instance in which the platen **120** sweeps the acoustic sensor **162** beneath the substrate **10**. Between each data point, the platen **120** undergoes a full rotation during which the acoustic sensor **162** is not beneath the substrate **10**. The data points of acoustic signal **310** depict a periodic motion oscillating on the y-axis with time, between a maximum (G) and a minimum (H). Without wishing to be bound by theory, in some implementations, the maximum (G) and minimum (H) correspond to structural features of the patterned layer, and in particular to parallel or perpendicular alignment of the features with respect to the direction of motion of the polishing pad below the substrate.

(37) The patterned layer of the substrate **10** is a non-uniform surface including circuitry dies forming a complex pattern of dielectric plateaus and conductor-filled trenches. The dies can be rectangular in shape, e.g., a rectangle, a square, and arranged in a regular array on the semiconductor layer. The dies being arranged in the array form a series of parallel register lines, e.g., edges of the dies or scribe lines between the dies, along the faces of the rectangular dies.

(38) FIGS. 4A and 4B depict the substrate **10** having a regular arrangement of parallel register lines **11** in two respective orientations with respect to the movement of an acoustic sensor **162**. The spacing of the register lines **11** is exemplary. The acoustic sensor **162** is shown sweeping beneath the substrate **10** along a direction of travel **200**. The direction of travel **200** is an approximation of the relative motion of the acoustic sensor **162** as the platen **120** sweeps the acoustic sensor **162** beneath the substrate **10**. In some implementations, the acoustic monitoring system **160** is configured to generate a measurement at each pass of the acoustic sensor **162** beneath the substrate **10**, e.g., as the acoustic sensor **162** passes across the diameter of the substrate **10**. In this manner acoustic signal **310** is a sequence of measurements generated at a sampling rate that corresponds to the rotation rate $\omega_{sub.P}$ of the platen **120**. The sampling rate corresponds to the time interval between sequential measurements of the acoustic signal **310**, e.g., the sampling rate corresponds with $\omega_{sub.P}$.

(39) In some implementations, the acoustic monitoring system **160** is configured to generate a single measurement at each pass at a point along the diameter of the substrate **10**. In alternative implementations, the acoustic monitoring system **160** is configured to generate multiple measurements at each pass at points spanning the diameter of the substrate **10**. In such implementations, the acoustic monitoring system **160** can process the multiple generated measurements into an averaged measurement in the sequence of measurements of acoustic signal **310**.

(40) FIG. 4A illustrates the register lines **11** aligning in parallel with the direction of travel **200** while FIG. 4B illustrates the register lines **11** aligning perpendicular with the direction of travel **200**. In general, the orientation of the register lines **11** relative to the direction of motion **200** will change as the platen **120** and substrate **10** rotate independently.

(41) The asperities of the polishing layer **112** sweeping beneath the substrate **10** along the direction of travel **200** create friction on the contacting surface of the substrate **10** and remove a portion of the substrate **10** material contacting the pad **110**. However, the respective alignments of the register lines **11** with the direction of travel **200** shown in FIGS. 4A and 4B generate different acoustic signals received by the acoustic sensor **162**. Said another way, the arrangement of the acoustic

window **119** and substrate **10** of FIG. **4A** in which the register lines **11** are parallel with the direction of travel **200** produces a first acoustic signal magnitude. The arrangement of FIG. **4B** in which the register lines **11** are perpendicular with the direction of travel **200** produces a second acoustic signal magnitude.

(42) For example, in some implementations, the arrangement of FIG. **4A** corresponds with the signal maxima (e.g., maximum G), and the arrangement of FIG. **4B** corresponds with the signal minima (e.g., minimum H). Between the periodic maxima and minima, e.g., G and H, the acoustic signal **310** consists of a sequence of measurement values, e.g., points of FIG. **3B**, each of which correspond to generated measurements at various angular orientations of the substrate **10**.

(43) As the acoustic window **119** sweeps beneath the substrate **10** at regular intervals given by $\omega_{\text{sub.P}}$, the substrate **10** will be at an angular orientation with respect to the direction of travel **200**. The platen **120** and the substrate **10** within the retaining ring **142** rotate at two rotational velocities, $\omega_{\text{sub.P}}$ and $\omega_{\text{sub.S}}$. The acoustic sensor **162** receives acoustic signals from the interface of the polishing layer **112** and the substrate **10** when the acoustic window **119** is beneath the substrate **10**. When the acoustic sensor **162** is not beneath the substrate **10**, no signal is received from the interface.

(44) Without wishing to be bound by theory, as the platen **120** rotates at the rotational speed W P the acoustic monitoring system **160** generates acoustic measurements at the sampling rate, described above. Between measurements, the substrate **10** rotates by a rotational distance, $\Delta\theta_{\text{sub.S}} \propto (\omega_{\text{sub.S}} - \omega_{\text{sub.P}}) / 2\pi$. FIGS. **5A** through **5E** illustrates the substrate **10** including the parallel register lines **11** at an exemplary sequence of angular orientations corresponding to measurements of the acoustic signal **310** collected at the sampling rate.

(45) The angular orientation of FIG. **5A** can correspond, in some implementations, to the signal maxima, G, of FIG. **3B** and orientation shown in FIG. **3B** as the register lines **11** and the direction of travel **200** are parallel. The substrate **10** rotates at rotational speed, $\omega_{\text{sub.S}}$, and the acoustic sensor **162** receives acoustic signals at the sampling rate. In the examples of FIGS. **5A** to **5E**, $\omega_{\text{sub.S}} > \omega_{\text{sub.P}}$ which results in a positive (e.g., counter-clockwise) $\Delta\theta_{\text{sub.S}}$. At each measurement, e.g., taken at a time of an integer value of the sampling rate, r , the $\Delta\theta_{\text{sub.S}}$ is increased as the substrate **10** processes.

(46) As the substrate **10** processes through the orientations depicted in FIGS. **5B** to **5D**, the received acoustic signal changes according to $\Delta\theta_{\text{sub.S}}$ corresponding to the acoustic signal **310** changes between maximum, G, and minimum, H.

(47) In FIG. **5E**, the register lines **11** are parallel with the direction of travel **200** and the measured signal, such as acoustic signal **310**, is returned to the acoustic signal magnitude of FIG. **5A**. As such, the examples of FIGS. **5A** to **5E** illustrate one exemplary periodic fluctuation of acoustic signal **310**.

(48) Referring again to FIG. **3B**, controller **190** receives the acoustic signal **310** and processes the measurements to determine one or more parameters of the acoustic signal **310**. For example, the controller **190** processes the received acoustic signal **310** and calculates frequency of oscillation, $F_{\text{sub.B}}$, of acoustic signal **310**. For example, a sinusoidal or similar function can be fit to the sequence of values in the acoustic signal **310**, and the frequency of oscillation $F_{\text{sub.B}}$ can be the frequency of the function resulting from the fitting. The determined parameters of the acoustic signal **310** can be used to obtain characteristics of the orientation of the substrate **10**, e.g., rotation rate estimate ($\omega_{\text{sub.S}}$) a variance of the rotation rate estimate, and a rotational orientation ($\theta_{\text{sub.S}}$).

(49) The controller **190** determines the substrate rotation rate and a continuous time-varying function representing the substrate **10** orientation through time, e.g., $\theta_{\text{sub.S}}(T)$, based on the determined parameters. In particular, assuming that the platen, carrier head and substrate rotation rates are not vastly different, e.g., by greater than a factor of two, then as shown by FIGS. **5A-5E** the frequency of oscillation, $F_{\text{sub.B}}$, should be twice the beat frequency. Assuming, the platen

rotates faster than the carrier head, and the carrier head rotates faster than the substrate, then $\omega_{sub.P} > \omega_{sub.P}$. Thus, the beat frequency should be $(\omega_{sub.P} - \omega_{sub.S}) = F_{sub.B}/2$. So the substrate rotation rate can be calculated as $\omega_{sub.S} = \omega_{sub.P} - F_{sub.B}/2$. The precession rate can be calculated as $\omega_{sub.S} - \omega_{sub.C}$. Thus, orientation of the substrate relative to the carrier head can be calculated as a function of time T , e.g., as a function including $(\omega_{sub.S} - \omega_{sub.C}) * T$. Using this data, the appropriate chamber **146a-i** that overlies a given angular region of the substrate can be calculated over time, and pressures can be selected over time in order to reduce asymmetric polishing.

(50) In addition, the orientation of the substrate can be periodically measured based on the acoustic signal, and the measured orientation can be used to compensate for potential discrepancy between the actual precession and calculated precession. In general, the peaks and/or valleys should correspond to specific orientations of the substrate relative to the direction of motion. The specific orientation(s) of the substrate that correspond to peaks and/or valleys can be determined empirically, e.g., by loading a substrate with known orientation into the carrier head before polishing and then monitoring the acoustic signal during a test polishing operation. The orientation of the substrate can be represented as an angle θ between the direction of motion **200** and a notch or flat **14** on an edge **12** of the substrate **10**. Assuming the correspondence between peaks and angular orientations are known, the angular difference between the carrier head and substrate can be periodically reset.

(51) For example, referring to FIG. 6, suppose that an indication in the acoustic signal, e.g., a peak, indicates that the substrate is at an orientation $\theta_{sub.S1}$ (the peaks or valleys may correspond to the alignment of the die edges with the direction of motion, in which case then $\theta_{sub.S1}$ would typically be 0° or 90°). Assuming that the controller detects the presence of a peak at time $t1$, the controller can then calculate the orientation of the substrate as $\theta = \theta_{sub.S1} + \omega_{sub.S} * (T - t1)$. In addition, the controller can capture the carrier head orientation $\theta_{sub.C1}$, at time $t1$, e.g., from motor encoder data. In this case, the controller can calculate the precession Δ , i.e., the difference between the carrier head orientation and substrate orientation, as $\Delta = (\theta_{sub.S1} - \theta_{sub.C1}) + (\omega_{sub.S} - \omega_{sub.C}) * (T - t1)$. The controller can then intermittently reset the calculation of the precession, obtaining new values for $t1$, $\theta_{sub.S1}$, and $\theta_{sub.C1}$, based on a more recently detected peak. Although the discussion above focuses on a peak as the indication, the technique could also be used with other indications, such as a valley, mid-line crossing, or inflection point. Calculation of the precession can be reset periodically, e.g., about once every 1 to 10 seconds, or each time the precession Δ exceeds a set value, e.g., 90° or 180° or 360° .

(52) In some implementations, an initial angle of orientation between the substrate **10** and the carrier head **70** can be measured before polishing commences. For example, the initial orientation can be measured at a transfer station.

(53) Referring to FIG. 7, the substrate can be loaded into the carrier head **140** at a transfer station **400** that includes a loading cup **410**. The loading cup **410** can include a support **412**, such as a pedestal, lift pins, or an edge support ring, to hold the substrate **10** before being loaded into and/or after being unloaded from the carrier head **140**. The support **412** can be rotatable and/or vertically actuatable, e.g., by a motor **414**. The loading cup **410** can also include one or more nozzles **420** to spray a cleaning fluid **422**, e.g., deionized water, on substrate **10** as the substrate sits on the support **412** and/or is held by the carrier head **140** at transfer station **400**.

(54) The transfer station **400** also includes a sensor **450**, e.g., an optical sensor, to determine the substrate orientation, e.g., angle relative to the load cup **410**. For example, the sensor **450** can generate a light beam **452** that is directed to an edge of the substrate **10** as the substrate sits on the support **412**, and detect reflections of the light beam from the substrate **10**. The support **412** can rotate; the notch or flat will generate a different reflected light intensity, so the controller can determine the initial substrate orientation $\theta_{sub.C0}$ based on a signal from the sensor **450**. An initial angular orientation $\theta_{sub.C0}$ of the carrier head **140**, e.g., relative to the load cup, can also be

measured when the carrier head is lowered or the substrate is raised to be chucked to the carrier head **140**. For example, the angular orientation of the carrier head can be monitored by a motor encoder **460** that is part of the motor **154**.

(55) Alternatively, the angular orientation of the substrate **10** could be measured after the substrate **10** is loaded onto the carrier head. For example, the sensor **450** could direct the light beam **452** onto the substrate **10** when the substrate is being held by the carrier head **140**, and the motor **154** can rotate the carrier head **140** for the controller to detect the notch and thus initial substrate orientation. For this, the initial angular orientation $\theta_{sub.C0}$ of the carrier head **140** can be the orientation at which the substrate is at the initial orientation $\theta_{sub.C0}$, e.g., the notch is aligned with the light beam.

(56) With these measurements, the controller **190** can calculate an initial angular difference $\Delta_{sub.0}$, as $\Delta_{sub.0} = \theta_{sub.S0} - \theta_{sub.C0}$. Thereafter, during polishing the angular difference can be calculated based on the precession rate determined from the acoustic signal as discussed above, i.e., $\Delta = \Delta_{sub.0} + (\omega_{sub.S} - \omega_{sub.C}) * (T - t_0)$, where t_0 is the time that the substrate is lowered into contact with the rotating platen. The controller **190** can also intermittently reset the calculation of the precession as discussed above, obtaining new values for t_1 , $\theta_{sub.S1}$, and $\theta_{sub.C1}$, based on a more recently detected peak.

(57) While this specification contains many details, these should not be construed as limitations on the scope of what may be claimed, but rather as descriptions of features specific to particular examples. Certain features that are described in this specification in the context of separate implementations can also be combined. Conversely, various features that are described in the context of a single implementation can also be implemented in multiple embodiments separately or in any suitable subcombination.

(58) A number of implementations have been described. Nevertheless, it will be understood that various modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention. Accordingly, other implementations are within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A chemical mechanical polishing system, comprising: polishing station including a platen to support a polishing pad; a rotatable carrier head to hold a surface of a substrate against the polishing pad; a motor to generate relative motion between the platen and the carrier head so as to polish an overlying layer on the substrate; an in-situ acoustic monitoring system comprising an acoustic sensor that receives acoustic signals from the surface of the substrate; and a controller configured to determine a rate of change of angular orientation of the substrate based on received acoustic signals from the in-situ acoustic monitoring system, to obtain a rotation rate of the carrier head, and to determine a difference in angular orientation between the substrate and the carrier head based on the rate of change of angular orientation of the substrate and the rotation rate of the carrier head.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the controller is configured to determine the difference in angular orientation based on the rate of change of angular orientation of the substrate, the rotation rate of the carrier head, a starting angular orientation of the substrate, and a starting angular orientation of the carrier head.
3. The system of claim 2, wherein the starting angular orientation of the substrate is an initial angular orientation of the substrate before polishing.
4. The system of claim 3, further comprising a transfer station including a sensor that generates a signal that depends on an angular orientation of the substrate, and wherein the controller is configured to receive a signal from the sensor in the transfer station and determine the initial angular orientation of the substrate on the signal.
5. The system of claim 4, wherein controller is configured to obtain the starting angular orientation

of the carrier head as an angular orientation of the carrier head when the substrate is loaded into the carrier head at the transfer station.

6. The system of claim 4, wherein the controller is configured to obtain the starting angular orientation of the carrier head as an angular orientation of the carrier head at the transfer station while the substrate is loaded in the carrier head and the angular orientation of the substrate is being determined.

7. The system of claim 2, wherein the starting angular orientation of the substrate is an angular orientation of the substrate during polishing.

8. The system of claim 7, wherein the controller is configured to determine the angular orientation of the substrate during polishing from the acoustic signals.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the controller is configured to obtain an indication in the acoustic signals which indicates an angular orientation of the substrate, the indication being a peak, valley, mid-line crossing, or inflection point of the signal, to detect the indication in the acoustic signals, and to set the starting angular orientation to the angular orientation.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein the controller is configured to repeatedly detect the indication in the acoustic signals, and to repeatedly reset the starting angular orientation to the angular orientation.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the controller is configured to reset the starting angular orientation every 1 to 10 seconds.

12. The system of claim 10, wherein the controller is configured to reset the starting angular orientation each time the difference in angular orientation between the substrate and the carrier head exceeds a set value.
